

Wine Pronunciation Guide

Grapes · Regions · Terms · Famous Estates — How to Say It Correctly

Each entry shows the phonetic spelling and the origin language. Common mistakes are noted where relevant. For audio pronunciation, use the interactive tool at kazmicellars.com

Red Grapes	
Cabernet Sauvignon KAB-er-nay so-VIN-yohn <i>French · The final 't' is silent</i>	Merlot mer-LOH <i>French · Never 'mer-LOT' — the 't' is always silent</i>
Pinot Noir PEE-noh NWAHR <i>French · Noir rhymes with 'war'</i>	Syrah see-RAH <i>French · Same grape as Shiraz — name changes by region</i>
Grenache greh-NAHSH <i>French · Called Garnacha in Spain</i>	Garnacha gar-NAH-chah <i>Spanish · Spanish name for Grenache</i>
Tempranillo tem-prah-NEE-yoh <i>Spanish · Double 'l' sounds like 'y' in Spanish</i>	Sangiovese san-joh-VAY-zeh <i>Italian · Backbone of Chianti, Brunello, and Morellino</i>
Nebbiolo neh-BYOH-loh <i>Italian · From 'nebbia' — Italian for fog</i>	Malbec MAL-bek <i>French · Called Cot in Loire, Auxerrois in Cahors</i>
Cabernet Franc KAB-er-nay FRONK <i>French · 'Franc' rhymes with 'bronze' not 'frank'</i>	Zinfandel ZIN-fan-del <i>English · Genetically identical to Italian Primitivo</i>
Primitivo pree-mee-TEE-voh <i>Italian · Southern Italian name for Zinfandel</i>	Mourvèdre moor-VED-ruh <i>French · Called Monastrell in Spain</i>
Monastrell mon-ah-STREL <i>Spanish · Spanish name for Mourvèdre</i>	Barbera bar-BAIR-ah <i>Italian · Common mistake: bar-BEAR-ah</i>
Gamay gah-MAY <i>French · The grape of Beaujolais</i>	Aglianico ah-LYAH-nee-koh <i>Italian · The 'gl' sounds like 'ly' — common mispronunciation</i>
Nero d'Avola NEH-roh DAH-voh-lah <i>Italian · Sicily's flagship red grape</i>	Carménère kar-meh-NAIR <i>French · Chile's defining grape — originally from Bordeaux</i>
Corvina kor-VEE-nah <i>Italian · Primary grape in Amarone and Valpolicella</i>	Nerello Mascalese neh-REL-loh mas-kah-LAY-zeh <i>Italian · The great red grape of Mount Etna, Sicily</i>

Xinomavro KSEE-noh-MAH-vroh <i>Greek · Means 'acid black' — Greece's greatest red</i>	Agiorgitiko ah-your-YEE-tee-koh <i>Greek · Also called Saint George's grape — from Nemea</i>
Touriga Nacional toh-REE-gah nah-syoh-NAHL <i>Portuguese · The soul of Vintage Port</i>	

White Grapes	
Chardonnay shar-doh-NAY <i>French · World's most planted white — from Burgundy</i>	Sauvignon Blanc SOH-veen-yohn BLONK <i>French · The 'c' in Blanc is silent</i>
Riesling REEZ-ling <i>German · Never 'RICE-ling' — a very common mistake</i>	Pinot Gris PEE-noh GREE <i>French · Alsace style — full-bodied and rich</i>
Pinot Grigio PEE-noh GREE-joh <i>Italian · Italian style — light and crisp</i>	Gewurztraminer geh-VURTS-trah-mee-ner <i>German · Means 'spicy grape from Tramin'</i>
Viognier vee-oh-NYAY <i>French · Common mistake: vee-OG-nee-ay</i>	Chenin Blanc SHEH-nan BLONK <i>French · The great white of the Loire Valley</i>
Albariño a l -bah-REE-nyoh <i>Spanish · The n with tilde sounds like 'ny'</i>	Grüner Veltliner GR00-ner FELT-lee-ner <i>German · Austria's flagship white grape</i>
Assyrtiko ah-SEER-tee-koh <i>Greek · Santorini's great volcanic white grape</i>	Vermentino ver-men-TEE-noh <i>Italian · The coastal Mediterranean white</i>
Muscat MUS-kat <i>French · Called Moscato in Italy</i>	Moscato mos-KAH-toh <i>Italian · Moscato d'Asti is gently sweet and low alcohol</i>
Furmint FOOR-mint <i>Hungarian · The soul of Tokaji — very high natural acid</i>	Marsanne mar-SAN <i>French · The richer of the two Rhone whites</i>
Roussanne roo-SAN <i>French · The more aromatic of the two Rhone whites</i>	Verdicchio ver-DIK-ee-oh <i>Italian · Central Italian white from Marche</i>
Garganega gar-GAH-neh-gah <i>Italian · The grape behind Soave Classico</i>	

French Regions & Terms	
Terroir tair-WAHR <i>French · No direct English translation — sense of place</i>	Sommelier sum-el-YAY <i>French · Often mispronounced 'SOM-el-yay'</i>
Chateau sha-TOH <i>French · Plural: Chateaux — also sha-TOH</i>	Bourgogne boor-GON-yuh <i>French · French name for Burgundy</i>
Bordeaux bor-DOH <i>French · The 'x' is silent — never bor-DOX</i>	Pauillac poh-YAK <i>French · Home to Lafite, Latour, Mouton Rothschild</i>
Margaux mar-GOH <i>French · The 'x' at the end is silent</i>	Medoc may-DOK <i>French · The Left Bank peninsula of Bordeaux</i>
Saint-Emilion san-ay-meeL-YOHN <i>French · Right Bank — home to Petrus and Cheval Blanc</i>	Pomerol pom-eh-ROHL <i>French · Tiny appellation — home to Petrus</i>
Beaujolais boh-zhoh-LAY <i>French · The 's' at the end is silent</i>	Meursault mer-SOH <i>French · Home to great white Burgundy</i>
Puligny-Montrachet poo-lee-NYEE mon-rah-SHAY <i>French · Both the 't' and final 'ch' are silent</i>	Chablis sha-BLEE <i>French · The 's' is silent — pure unoaked Chardonnay</i>
Chateauneuf-du-Pape sha-toh-nuf-doo-PAP <i>French · 'New castle of the Pope'</i>	Cote-Rotie coat roh-TEE <i>French · 'Roasted slope' — great Northern Rhone Syrah</i>
Condrieu kon-dree-UH <i>French · The definitive home of Viognier</i>	Hermitage er-mee-TAHZH <i>French · The 'H' is silent in French</i>
Alsace al-ZAS <i>French · The final 'e' is silent</i>	Vouvray voo-VRAY <i>French · Loire Chenin Blanc — dry through to sweet</i>
Sancerre son-SAIR <i>French · Home to France's finest Sauvignon Blanc</i>	Pouilly-Fume poo-YEE foo-MAY <i>French · Not to be confused with Pouilly-Fuisse (Chardonnay)</i>
Champagne sham-PAN-yuh <i>French · In French: sham-PAN-yuh — not sham-PAIN</i>	Sauternes soh-TAIRN <i>French · The 's' at the end is silent</i>
Negociant nay-goh-SYOHN <i>French · A merchant who buys and sells wine</i>	Domaine doh-MAIN <i>French · An estate that grows its own grapes</i>

Grand Cru GROHN KROO <i>French · 'Great growth' — the highest classification</i>	Premier Cru preh-MYAY KROO <i>French · 'First growth' — second tier in Burgundy</i>
Vendange von-DOHNZH <i>French · The harvest</i>	Elevage ay-luh-VAHZH <i>French · The raising or aging of wine in barrel</i>

Italian Regions & Terms

Barolo bah-ROH-loh <i>Italian · 'The King of wines' — Nebbiolo from Piedmont</i>	Barbaresco bar-bah-RES-koh <i>Italian · Nebbiolo's more elegant sibling</i>
Brunello di Montalcino broo-NEL-loh dee mon-tal-CHEE-noh <i>Italian · 5+ years aging required before release</i>	Chianti Classico kee-AHN-tee KLAS-ee-koh <i>Italian · The heartland Chianti — Gallo Nero logo</i>
Amarone ah-mah-ROH-neh <i>Italian · From dried grapes — means 'the bitter one'</i>	Valpolicella val-pol-ee-CHEL-lah <i>Italian · Lighter Corvina-based red from Veneto</i>
Prosecco proh-SEK-oh <i>Italian · Italian sparkling — Glera grape, not Champagne method</i>	Sassicaia sas-ee-KAY-ah <i>Italian · The original Super Tuscan</i>
Tignanello teen-yah-NEL-loh <i>Italian · Antinori's famous Super Tuscan blend</i>	Ornellaia or-nel-LYE-ah <i>Italian · Bolgheri estate — home of Masseto Merlot</i>
Soave SWAH-veh <i>Italian · Garganega-based white from Veneto</i>	Dolcetto dol-CHET-toh <i>Italian · Piedmont red — means 'little sweet one'</i>
Frascati fras-KAH-tee <i>Italian · Rome's local white wine</i>	

Spanish & Portuguese

Rioja ree-OH-hah <i>Spanish · The 'j' sounds like an 'h' — ree-OH-hah</i>	Ribera del Duero ree-BAIR-ah del DWAIR-oh <i>Spanish · Spain's Napa Valley — Tempranillo country</i>
Priorat pree-oh-RAHT <i>Catalan · Garnacha on black slate — llicorella</i>	Rias Baixas REE-as BY-shas <i>Galician · 'Baixas' is Galician for 'lower'</i>
Cava KAH-vah <i>Spanish · Spanish sparkling wine — traditional method</i>	Jerez heh-RETH <i>Spanish · Sherry country — the 'j' sounds like 'h'</i>

Manzanilla man - tha - NEE - yah <i>Spanish · Dry Sherry from Sanlucar — saline and delicate</i>	Verdejo ver - DEH - hoh <i>Spanish · Rueda's white grape</i>
Vinho Verde VEEN - yoh VAIR - deh <i>Portuguese · Means 'green wine' — fresh, Atlantic style</i>	Douro DOH - roh <i>Portuguese · Port wine's home river and region</i>

German & Austrian	
Spatelse SHPAYT - lay - zeh <i>German · 'Late harvest' — riper, slightly richer Riesling</i>	Auslese OWS - lay - zeh <i>German · 'Selected harvest' — often off-dry or sweet</i>
Beerenauslese BAIR - en - OWS - lay - zeh <i>German · 'Berry selected harvest' — sweet botrytis</i>	Trockenbeerenauslese TROK - en - BAIR - en - OWS - lay - zeh <i>German · The ultimate German sweet wine designation</i>
Eiswein ICE - vine <i>German · 'Ice wine' — made from frozen grapes</i>	Kabinett kah - bee - NET <i>German · Lightest Pradikat — delicate, low alcohol</i>
Trocken TROK - en <i>German · Bone dry — on a German wine label</i>	Mosel MOH - ze l <i>German · The river and region — slate soils, elegant Riesling</i>
Rheingau RINE - gow <i>German · The Rhine bend — classic Riesling country</i>	Wachau VAH - khow <i>German · Austrian Danube valley — finest Gruner Veltliner</i>
Smaragd smah - RAHGT <i>German · Highest Wachau quality tier — named after a lizard</i>	

Winemaking Terms	
Tannin TAN - in <i>English · Polyphenols from grape skins — creates drying feel</i>	Malolactic mal - oh - LAK - tik <i>English · Converts sharp malic acid to soft lactic acid</i>
Botrytis boh - TRY - tis <i>English · Noble rot — concentrates sugars for sweet wine</i>	Phylloxera fil - LOK - ser - ah <i>English · The louse that destroyed Europe's vineyards in 1800s</i>
Maceration mas - er - AY - shun <i>English · Skin contact — extracts colour, tannin, and flavour</i>	Lees LEEZ <i>English · Dead yeast cells — sur lie aging adds texture</i>
Sur Lie sur LEE <i>French · Aging wine on its lees — adds creaminess</i>	Dosage doh - ZAHZH <i>French · Sugar added to Champagne after disgorgement</i>

Disgorgement dis-GORJ-ment <i>English · Removing frozen sediment plug from Champagne</i>	Elevage ay-luh-VAHZH <i>French · The raising or aging of wine</i>
Brut BROOT <i>French · Dry Champagne — less than 12g/L residual sugar</i>	Demi-Sec deh-mee SEK <i>French · Half-dry — actually noticeably sweet on the palate</i>
Appellation ah-pel-AY-shun <i>English · Legally defined geographic wine region</i>	Millesime mee-lay-SEEM <i>French · Vintage year — a millesime Champagne is vintage-dated</i>
Varietal var-EYE-eh-tal <i>English · Wine named after a single grape variety</i>	Barrique bah-REEK <i>French · 225-litre French oak barrel</i>
Negociant nay-goh-SYOHN <i>French · A merchant who buys grapes or wine to sell</i>	

Famous Estates & Wines	
Romanee-Conti ro-mah-NAY CON-tee <i>French · The world's most expensive wine — 1.8 ha monopole</i>	Petrus PAY-troos <i>French · Pomerol's iconic Merlot — often the priciest Bordeaux</i>
Mouton Rothschild moo-TOHN ROHTS-child <i>French · Only chateau elevated to First Growth (1973)</i>	Haut-Brion oh-bree-YOHN <i>French · Only non-Medoc First Growth — from Pessac-Leognan</i>
Lafite Rothschild lah-FEET ROHTS-child <i>French · The 'te' in Lafite is silent</i>	Chateau d'Yquem sha-TOH dee-KEM <i>French · World's greatest sweet wine — Premier Cru Superieur</i>
Sassicaia sas-ee-KAY-ah <i>Italian · The Super Tuscan that changed Italian wine</i>	Tignanello teen-yah-NEL-loh <i>Italian · Antinori's pioneering Super Tuscan</i>
Vega Sicilia VAY-gah see-THEEL-ee-ah <i>Spanish · Spain's most celebrated wine estate</i>	Domaine Leroy doh-MAIN luh-RWAH <i>French · DRC's great Burgundy rival — Lalou Bize-Leroy</i>
Condrieu kon-dree-UH <i>French · The definitive home of Viognier</i>	Gaja GAH-yah <i>Italian · Angelo Gaja — the modernizer of Piedmont</i>